Builders World

A 3D world where every building is generated from someone's real work. Product requirements, v1.1.

Working title. Author: Elvis Obi. v1.0 on 5 October 2026. Revised 9 October 2026.

What changed in v1.1

Five reference images now set the look and the in-world experience. Where they disagree with v1.0, the images win. They live in `assets/reference/generated-visual-direction/`:

- `gameplay-screenshot-yaba-objective.png`: the target for a Yaba street in play, with the HUD.
- `gameplay-loop-explore-connect-build.png`: the core loop.
- `hybrid-visual-language-board.png`: world, character, motion and materials.
- `storm-physics-and-atmosphere.png`: weather and ambient life.
- `yaba-blue-hour-street.png`: the mood of a lived-in Yaba street.

They are AI-generated concept art, not renders. They show where we are aiming, not what a browser can draw today.

Rules this revision replaces:

v1.0 rule	v1.1 rule
Flat shading, no textures, vertex colours only	Chunky readable forms with textured materials: wet concrete, painted walls, brushed metal, glass, foliage
Night as the base, nothing warm except amber	Blue hour into night, usually after rain. Amber still means activity on a plot. Lagos colour is allowed on surfaces
Minimal avatars, two dots for a face at most	Stylised characters with full faces and streetwear

v1.0 rule	v1.1 rule
Nothing idles	The street is alive: rain, wind, traffic, people. Plots still only change when work changes
Five emotes	Five emotes plus a two-person high five
User-built plots are out of scope	Personal plots stay generated. Residents build together in marked community areas, using an in-game kit
Weather is a month-seven drop	Rain and storms are part of the base look

The HTML and PDF exports in `docs/product/exports/` are still v1.0. Regenerate them once this revision is accepted.

What this is

A persistent, browser-based 3D world for indie builders and open source developers. People link the accounts where their work already lives. The world reads that activity and draws them a plot. Ship consistently and your building grows and lights up. Stop and it goes dark.

Nobody lives here. People visit for ten or fifteen minutes to see who is shipping, say hello, leave a note, and go back to work. The world keeps updating while they are gone.

> The 3D is the marketing. The verified identity graph across GitHub, Stripe and Product Hunt is the product.

Problem

Building in public happens on timelines. Timelines reward posting, not shipping. There is no place where a builder's actual output, verified and current, is the thing on display, and no place where you can bump into other builders with that context already loaded.

Precedent

Two browser games out of Lagos in the last month prove the audience and the surge both exist.

- Lagos Run, by Eureka (Opeyemi Adeniran). A browser game about driving a danfo from Ojuelegba to Yaba. It went viral and inspired the next one.
- Lagos Life, by Shalom Rayhamen (Eliy). A Sims-style multiplayer life sim set in Lagos, launched around 1 October 2026. Free, browser only, no install. Day one: 1,500 players. Day three: over a million visits and 250,000 active players. Within a week a tracker reported 40,000 concurrent players. Built by one developer on Next.js, client-rendered, shipped as a PWA for full-screen mobile play.

What this sets for us:

- The audience is real and it is here. Lagos is already the place where browser worlds happen. Yaba is the first district.
- The surge plan is not theoretical. 40,000 concurrent in a week from a standing start is the number to design for, not 2,000.
- The bar is a 2D game's load time. Lagos Life opens in seconds on a phone. A 3D world that takes 30 seconds to load will lose to it.
- Solo-dev speed matters more than polish at launch. Lagos Life shipped in weeks. Phase 1 should too.

Where we differ: Lagos Life is a game about a fictional life. Ours is a world drawn from real work. Nothing in it is decorated by the player. That is the difference and the moat.

Who it is for

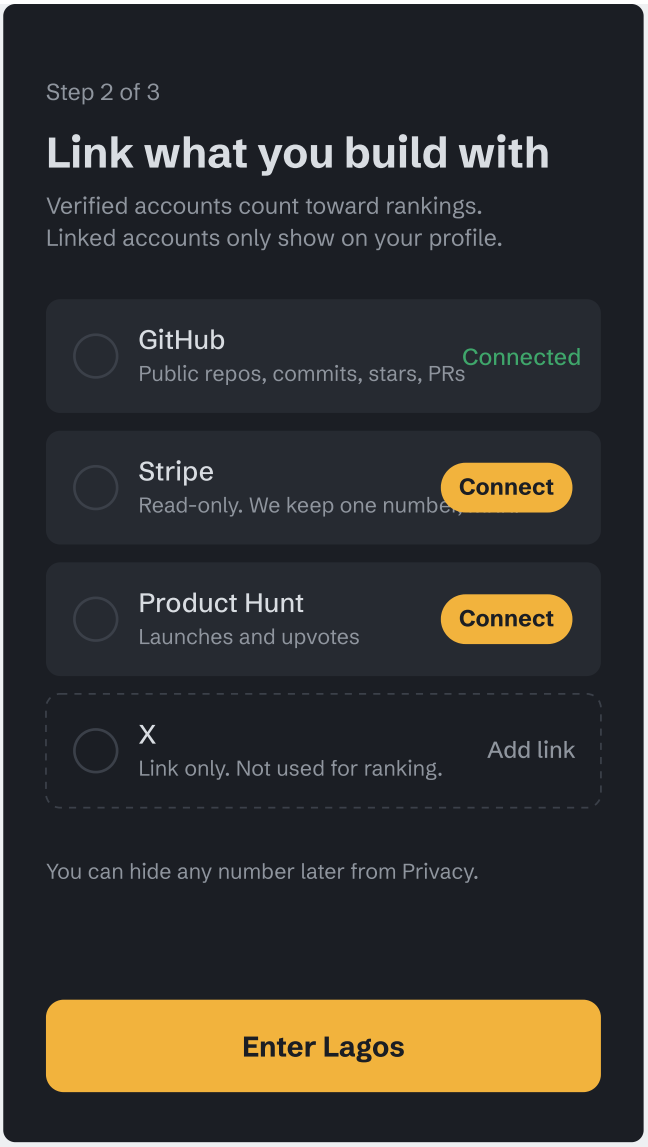
- v1: developers who ship in public. Solo founders, open source maintainers, indie hackers.
- v2: designers with public portfolios, and dev YouTubers.
- Paying later: scouts, investors and recruiters who want verified deal flow and hiring signal.

Product principles

- The world updates whether you log in or not. Work is tracked at the source. Logging in is never how you get counted.
- Verified or it does not count. OAuth with read-only scope, or it is a badge on the profile and nothing more.
- Leagues, not one score. Developers against developers. Cities against cities. No universal wealth number.
- Consistency over volume, outcomes over activity. 200 days of pushing beats one viral week.
- The world is big, the leaderboard is small. Status comes from walking up to a plot and seeing real work.
- Store derived numbers, never raw data. Keep the MRR figure, not the customer list.

Core experience

Onboarding



Account linking. Verified sources get a connect action and a plain statement of what is read. Link-only sources are visually lighter so nobody confuses the two.

Sign in with GitHub. Pick a home city. Connect Stripe and Product Hunt if you have them. Choose what is public. Enter your district. Under two minutes.

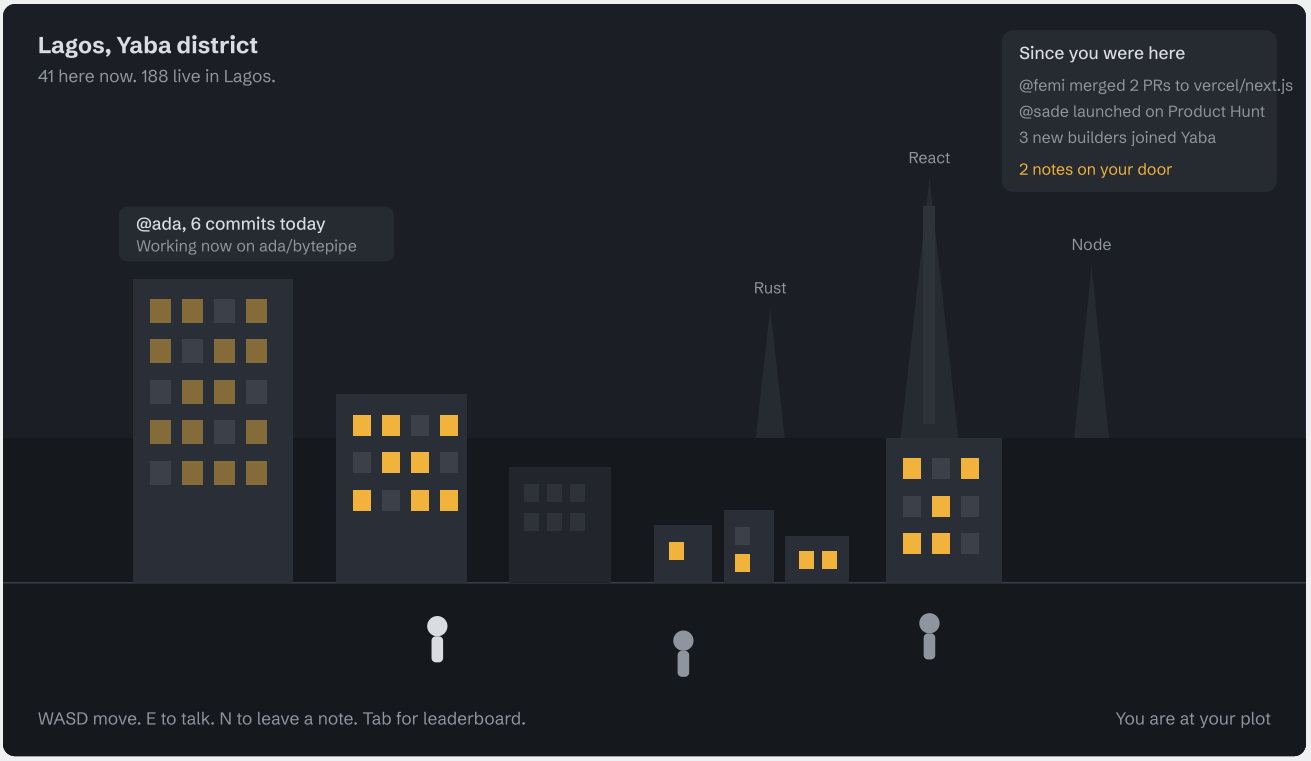
Figure: Account linking. Verified sources get a connect action and a plain statement of what is read. Link-only sources are visually lighter so nobody confuses the two.

The loop: explore, connect, build

Same people. Brighter places.

i. Explore. Follow the route, discover the district, see who is around.
ii. Connect. Meet builders, see who is nearby, share ideas, leave notes.
iii. Build. Improve a shared community area together and watch the district grow.

The world



District view. Building height comes from outcomes (stars, forks, MRR). Lit windows come from the last 24 hours. Pulsing windows mean the owner's presence agent says they are working now. The dark building has not pushed in weeks.

You spawn at your plot. Neighbours' windows are lit if they pushed in the last 24 hours and pulsing if they are working right now. Library monuments sit on the horizon. A small feed shows what your district did since you last visited.

The camera sits behind your character, third person. The street feels lived in: danfos and cars on the road, people walking and sitting, vendors under umbrellas, string lights, murals. Other builders have a name tag with a presence dot above their head.

In-world interface

Signs in the world are physical objects. Controls are a crisp overlay on top. The overlay has:

- District name and the current objective, top left. Example: "Yaba District. Meet the builders at the community board." Objectives can be a short checklist.
- A round minimap with north marked, top right. Community build areas are marked on it.

- A route drawn on the ground to the current objective, with a distance marker.
- A contextual prompt when something can be used. Example: "E. Open community board."
- A small controls card for new visitors: WASD to move, mouse to look.
- A Builders Nearby panel: avatar, name, what they are doing, and a voice indicator.
- An arrival progress bar while a district loads.

Community board

Every district has a board at the spawn point. It holds pinned notes, photos and ideas from the people who live there. Using it gives three actions: meet builders, read notes, leave a note.

Build together

Residents can improve their district, but only in community build areas. Everything else in the world, including personal plots, roads, landmarks and monuments, cannot be changed by players.

What a community build area is:

- A fixed space set aside for things that help the community grow. Examples: a corner that needs a bench or a waste bin, a broken streetlight, an empty lot that could be a playground or a garden, a stretch of waterfront that could get seating or a water point.
- Each area has a type, like street corner, playground, garden or waterfront. The type decides which pieces can go there.
- Areas are placed by us when a district is generated, not claimed by players.

How you find one:

- A physical marker in the world shows the area is open for building. Something like a signpost or a painted outline on the ground, consistent across every district, so people learn to spot it.
- The area is also marked on the minimap. Walking into it shows a prompt to start building.

How building works:

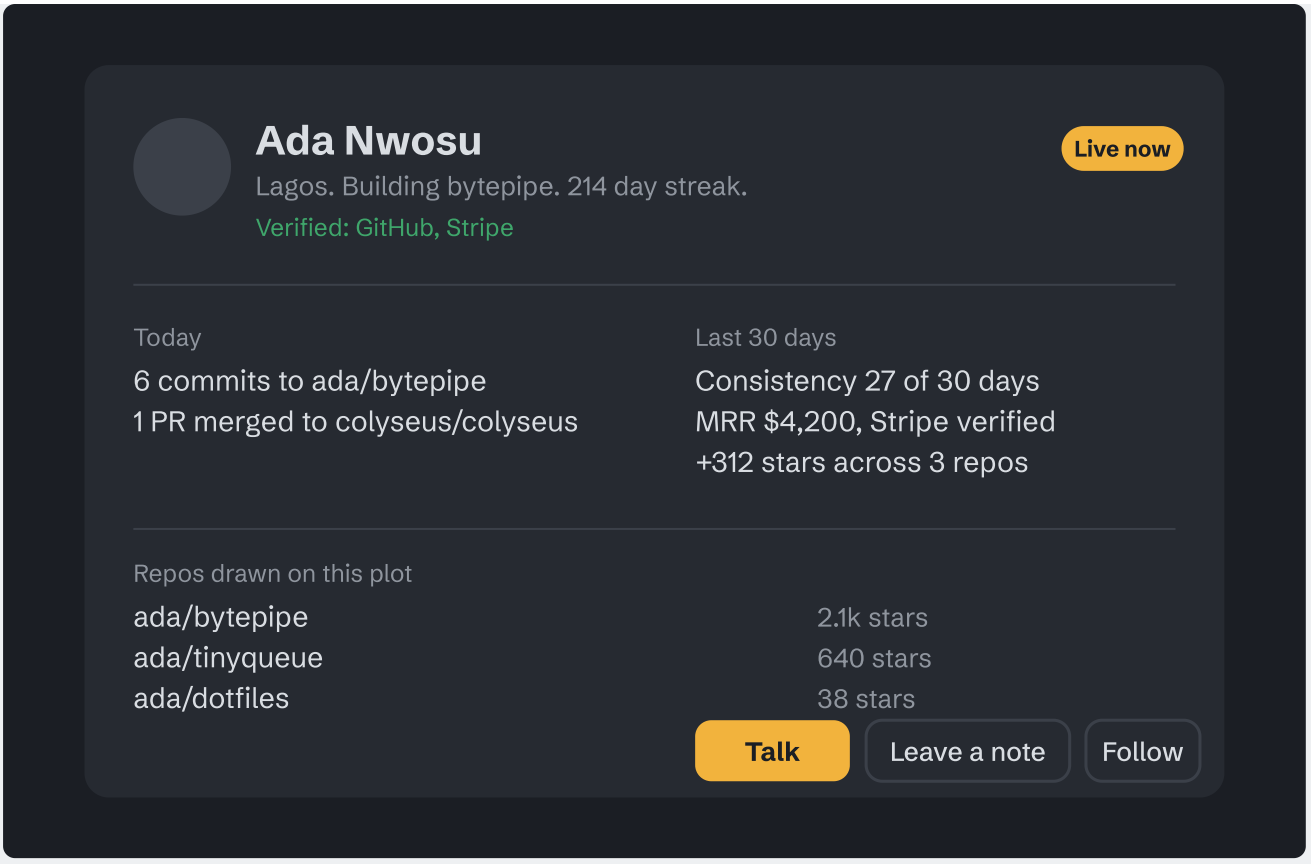
- Pieces come only from the in-game community kit: benches, waste bins, streetlights, playground pieces, garden beds, planters, trees, water points and

waterfront seating. No uploaded models, images or text.
- Repairs count. Fixing a broken streetlight is a build action, just like adding something new.
- Pieces snap to set points inside the area. You see a glowing preview, rotate it, then confirm or cancel.
- Nothing can block a path, a door or a plot entrance.
- Each area has a limit on how many pieces it holds, so it fills up rather than getting cluttered.
- Several residents can build in the same area at once and see each other's changes as they happen.
- Finished areas stay. They are part of the district's history, like round markers.

This is the one place players add to the world. Personal plots are still generated from verified work and nobody decorates their own. Who can build, how often, and how changes get reviewed are open questions below.

Figure: District view. Building height comes from outcomes (stars, forks, MRR). Lit windows come from the last 24 hours. Pulsing windows mean the owner's presence agent says they are working now. The dark building has not pushed in weeks.

Plot card

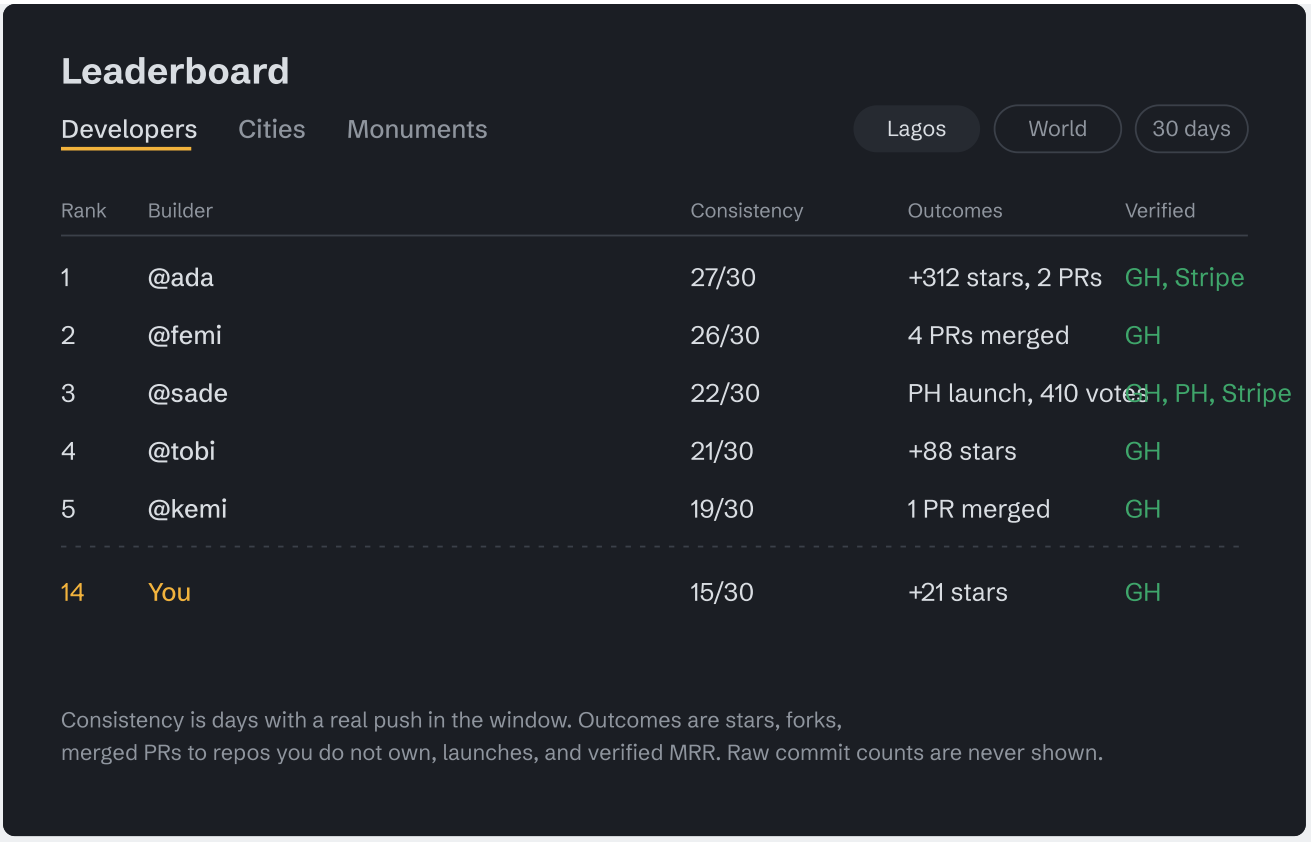


Plot card. MRR shows only because this owner turned it on. Hidden by default.

Walk up to a building, or tap it, and you get the owner's card. Only what they have chosen to show. Verified sources are marked. Actions are talk, leave a note, follow.

Figure: Plot card. MRR shows only because this owner turned it on. Hidden by default.

Leaderboards



Leaderboard. Your own row is pinned under the fold so the top five is not the only thing that matters.

Small, tabbed, and always inside a league. Developers, designers (v2), cities. Filter by home city or world, and by window. Verified badge on every row that earned it.

Figure: Leaderboard. Your own row is pinned under the fold so the top five is not the only thing that matters.

Notes on the door

Async messages left on a plot. The owner reads them next visit. No notification pressure, no inbox. This is the main way strangers start talking.

Chat

- Proximity voice and text in the world. Fades with distance.
- Direct messages, gated. Unverified accounts cannot send. New accounts are rate limited. Users choose: mutuals only, same district, anyone.
- Mute, block, report on every surface including voice. Blocked users are not rendered for you.
- Moderated spaces and open spaces. Default to moderated.
- Recruiter and investor messages are labelled and come from paid seats.

How the world is generated

Nobody models this by hand. A kit of around 30 parametric building pieces and a rule set turn a builder's numbers into a structure. One city at a time, and only districts with people in them exist.

- Height from outcomes: stars, forks, verified MRR, merged PRs to others' repos.
- Footprint from breadth: number of active repos.
- Lit windows from the last 24 hours. Pulsing from live presence.
- Decay: no push for 14 days dims the plot, 60 days darkens it. Nothing is ever deleted.
- Monuments: popular libraries get a landmark. Contributors cluster around it, so the map is the dependency graph.
- Districts: a city under 50 builders is a single crossroads. Over 50, it splits into named districts, 40 to 60 people per instance.

Art direction

Illustration

Hybrid: chunky, readable forms with real materials, at blue hour after rain. The style still has three jobs: read at a distance, survive procedural assembly, and carry data. Anything that fights one of those is wrong however good it looks in a screenshot. The reference images show the target.

- Forms stay chunky with strong silhouettes. A plot is recognisable from its outline at 200 metres. Kit pieces are slightly oversized at the top.
- Textured materials, shared across the kit: wet concrete, brushed metal, painted walls, glass, foliage. Textures are made offline and baked into the kit, never generated live. A district palette is still a material swap, not a new asset set.
- Blue hour into night as the base. Cool sky fill, warm amber window and lamp light, volumetric fog for depth.
- Wet ground. Streets and pavements reflect lamps, windows and signs. Puddles ripple in the rain.
- Amber still carries data. A plot's lit windows are amber and only amber. The street can have other light, like streetlamps, shop signs and car lights, as long as it never reads as plot activity.
- Lagos colour lives on surfaces: danfo yellow, painted walls, murals in teal, coral

and green, fabrics. Each district still gets one secondary colour so Yaba and Lekki are tellable apart.
- Lagos is recognisable. Danfos, overhead power lines, street vendors, palms and banana plants, balconies with laundry, flyovers, and the Lekki-Ikoyi Link Bridge and the skyline on the horizon.
- Weather is part of the place. Rain is the default mood. Storms bring heavier rain, wind in the palms and flags, and lightning over the water.
- Stylised characters with full faces and expressive features. Streetwear: caps and beanies, oversized tees, cargo trousers, sneakers, backpacks and crossbody bags. The character board's palette is green, coral, cream, navy and amber. The final default avatar is still to come from Elvis.
- Community build areas share one visual marker across every district, and pieces from the community kit match the rest of the world. Nothing a player builds should look pasted in.
- References: the five images in `assets/reference/generated-visual-direction/` come first. Townscaper still applies to how modular buildings assemble.
- Not this: voxels, photoreal, anime, isometric pixel art, neon sci-fi holograms.
- The flat site and admin invert it. Daylight, white, the same amber accent, the same chunky silhouettes as 2D icons. Same family, different time of day.
- Every look has a lower quality tier. Fog, reflections, rain density and shadows scale down so the world still runs on a laptop with no real GPU.

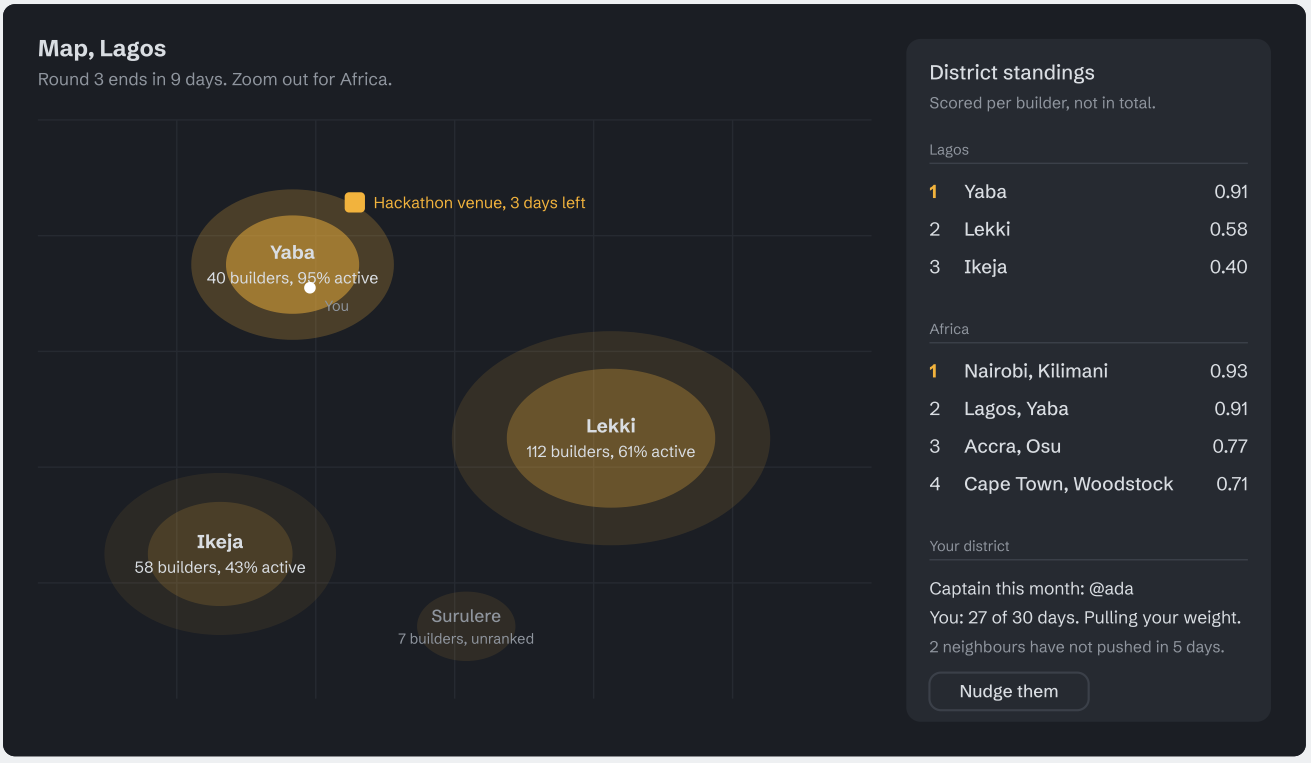
Animation

Two kinds of motion. The street is alive all the time. Data motion is slow and only happens when something changed.

- The street moves. Rain falls, palms and flags move in the wind, danfos drive past, people walk, sit and talk. This never changes what a plot says.
- Plots do not idle. Buildings do not sway and windows only change when work changes. UI does not float.
- Lights behave like bulbs. A push turns one window on in about 400ms with a touch of overshoot. Presence is a slow breath at about 2.5 seconds, never a strobe. Decay goes out one window at a time over days.
- Growth happens while you are away. If someone is watching when a floor is added, it rises in about 600ms with a slight squash at the top. One floor, then stop.
- Avatars walk, they do not run. Talking shows as a soft ring at the feet. Five emotes: wave, point, nod, clap, sit. Two people can high five. Greetings can carry

small hand-drawn marks, like the lines in the motion board.
- Camera never shakes. Third person, damped follow. District to district is a cut via the map, not a flight.
- One orchestrated moment: arrival. Fade from black, your plot first, then the street lights up outward over about 1.5 seconds.
- Monuments sweep a slow light, like a lighthouse. No animated geometry.
- Fireworks once a month in district colour for ten seconds when a round closes. The only celebration in the world.
- HUD eases 150 to 250ms from the edge it belongs to. No bounce. Standings tick, they do not scroll.
- Pulses and sweeps live in shaders driven by a uniform, never per-mesh JavaScript. 3,000 windows have to pulse at 60fps on a laptop with no real GPU.
- Respect prefers-reduced-motion. Pulses become steady lit, arrival becomes a fade, fireworks become a banner, rain gets lighter and wind stops.
- Lightning never flashes more than three times in any second, for anyone. With reduced motion it is off.

Districts and the map



The map. Patch size is headcount, brightness is activity. The standings score is participation per builder, so a tight 40-person district outranks a loose 112-person one.

A district is the unit people belong to. It is a village: a name, a colour, a board at the spawn point, and you can see all of it at once. The map draws districts as patches, sized by builders and brightened by activity. The same view works at every scale. Zoom in on Lagos and you see Yaba, Lekki, Ikeja. Zoom out and Lagos, Nairobi, Accra, Cape Town and Cairo are patches of their own. Zoom out again and continents compare.

Figure: The map. Patch size is headcount, brightness is activity. The standings score is participation per builder, so a tight 40-person district outranks a loose 112-person one.

District competition

Districts compete in monthly rounds. The score is per head, never total. Total output lets the biggest district win every round forever. Per-head scoring lets a small, disciplined district beat a large, loose one, which is the whole point.

- Round score is the share of verified builders with a qualifying push on each day, averaged over the round, with a small bonus for outcomes per head. It is one number between 0 and 1.
- A district needs 10 verified builders to enter a ranked round. Under that, it plays unranked and still shows on the map.
- Home district locks for 90 days after joining or moving. Without this everyone migrates to the winner and the competition dies.
- A district caught in coordinated gaming (shared machines, timed trivial pushes across many accounts) forfeits the round. Individuals are reviewed separately. This makes neighbours police each other.
- The captain rotates monthly to the builder with the highest consistency. No elections. The captain can post to the district board, propose a hackathon, and nudge inactive neighbours. Nothing else.
- Winning a round leaves a permanent marker on the district board and on every participating plot. Nothing is taken from the losers.
- Rounds roll up. District rounds feed a city table, city tables feed a continent table. Same per-head rule all the way up.

Hosted hackathons

A district hosts. A venue spawns in it for the length of the event, teams form on the floor, judges walk it, and the result is a permanent marker on every plot that took

part. A real hackathon in Yaba gets a mirror venue in the world, so someone in Enugu or Kigali is in the room. The organiser pays for the venue.

- Any verified organiser can request a venue. Captains can propose one for their district. Admins approve.
- Venue has its own board, its own voice rooms, a team formation wall, and a submissions list that links to repos. Submissions must be public repos created during the event window.
- Judges are named accounts with a judge badge for the event. Scoring is visible on the venue board when the event ends.
- Venues are torn down after the event. The marker on plots, the results board and the recording of the closing stay.
- Pricing is per venue per day, with a free tier for student and community events under 50 people. This is the first partner product.

Data sources and verification

Source	Method	Used for	Counts in ranking	Phase
GitHub	OAuth, public scope only, webhooks	Pushes, PRs, stars, forks	Yes	1
Stripe	Connect, read-only	MRR as a single number	Yes	1
Product Hunt	OAuth	Launches, votes	Yes	1
GitLab	OAuth, webhooks	Same as GitHub	Yes	2
Paddle, Lemon Squeezy	API key, read-only	MRR	Yes	2
YouTube	OAuth	Uploads, views (creator league)	Separate league	2
X, LinkedIn	Link only	Profile link	No	1
Behance, Dribbble, Figma	Link only until an API is confirmed	Profile link	No	2

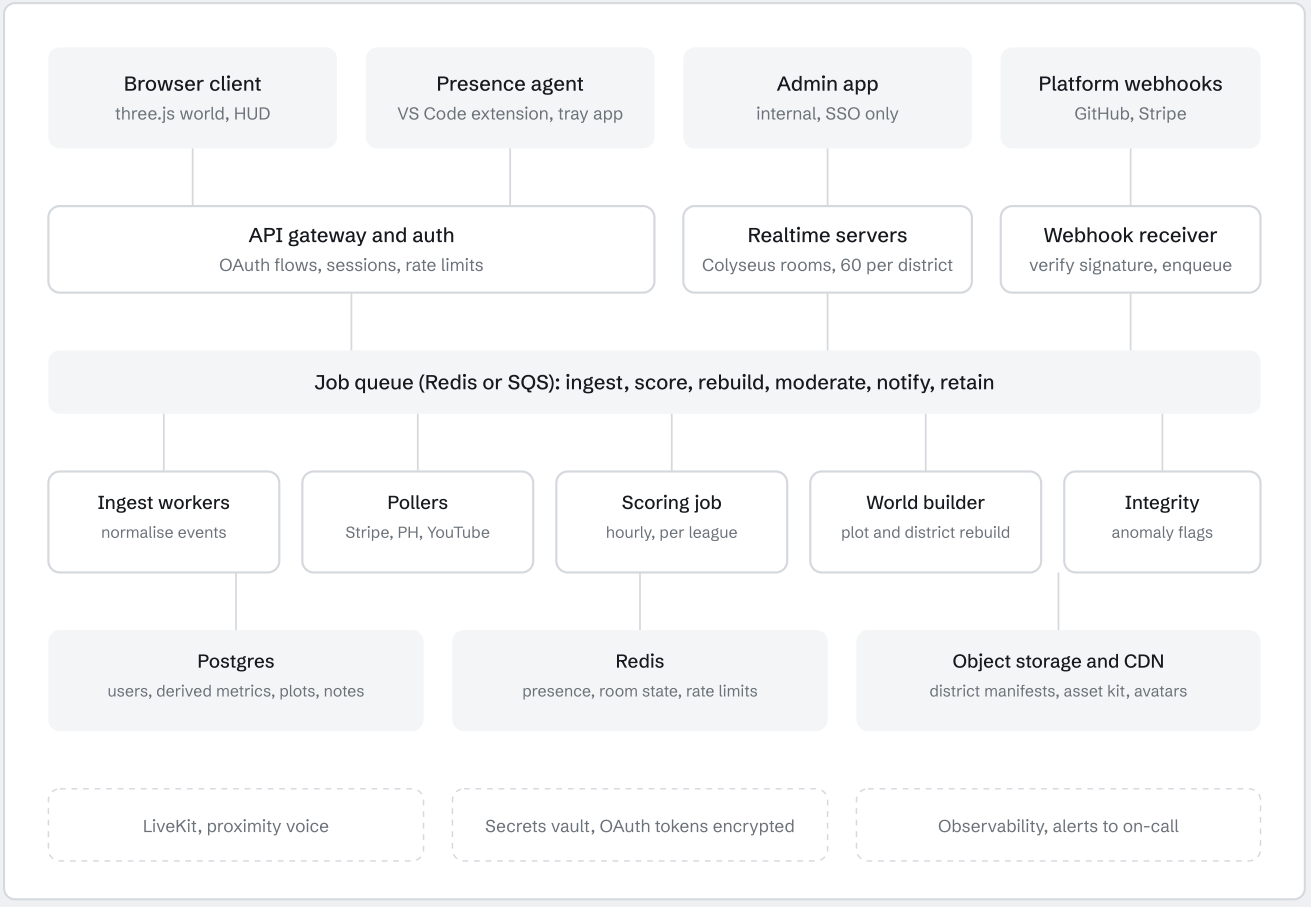
Rule: if the user cannot grant read access through the platform itself, the data is a link on the profile and never an input to a score.

Scoring

Two numbers per league, shown separately, never combined into one.

- Consistency: days with a qualifying push in the window. A qualifying push changes more than a trivial diff and is not from a bot-pattern account.
- Outcomes: stars and forks weighted by recency, merged PRs to repos you do not own weighted highest, launches, verified MRR.
- Anti-gaming: commit bursts, timestamp-only diffs and star velocity spikes are flagged, held out of the leaderboard, and reviewed. See the integrity dashboard.

System architecture



Everything the world shows is read from Postgres and the district manifests. Raw platform payloads are discarded after normalisation.

Figure: Everything the world shows is read from Postgres and the district manifests. Raw platform payloads are discarded after normalisation.

Background services

These run without anyone logged in. They are the product more than the 3D client is.

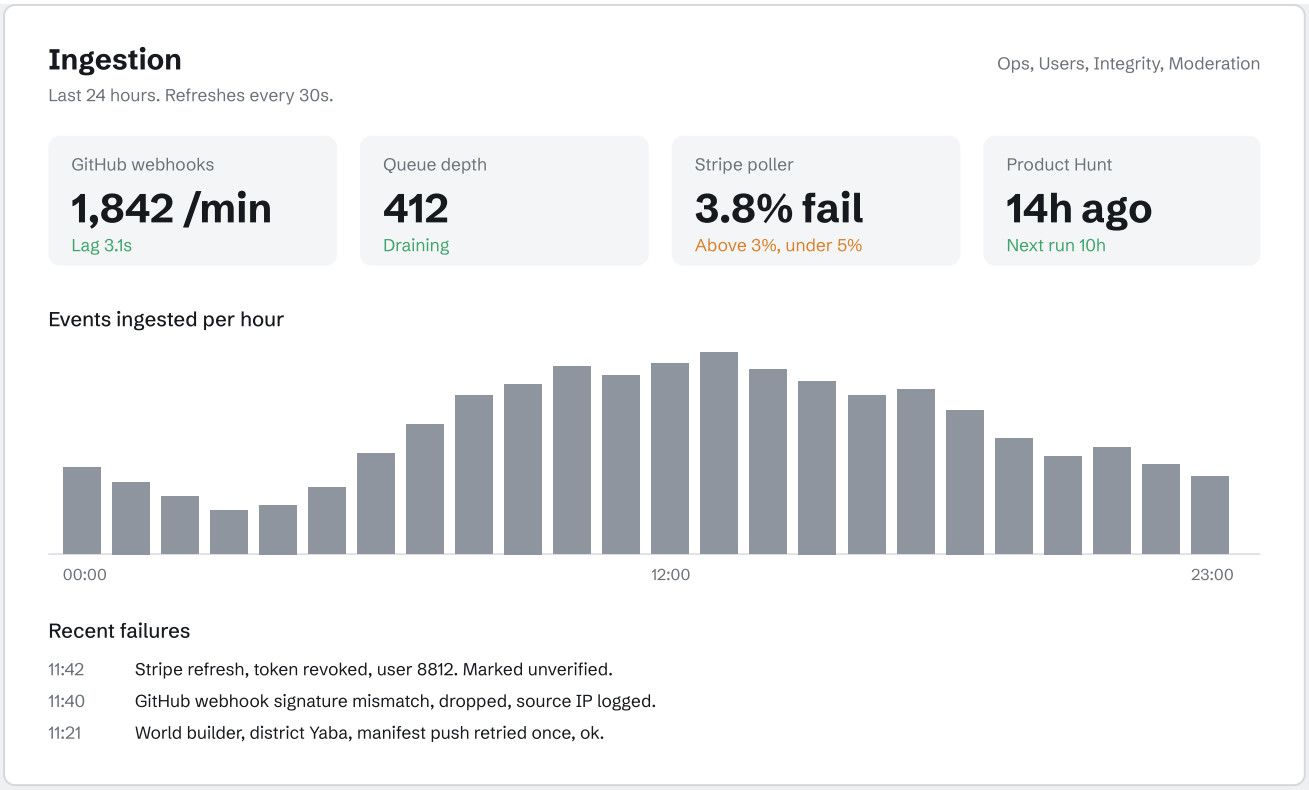
Service	Trigger	What it does	Alert if
Webhook receiver	GitHub, Stripe events	Verify signature, dedupe, enqueue	Lag over 60s or 5xx rate over 1%
Ingest workers	Queue	Normalise events, write derived metrics, discard payload	Queue depth over 10k
Stripe poller	Every 6 hours per user	Refresh MRR figure	Failure rate over 5%
Product Hunt poller	Daily, hourly on launch day	Launches and votes	Stale over 48h
YouTube poller	Daily	Uploads and views (v2)	Quota exhausted
Scoring job	Hourly	Recompute consistency and outcomes per league, per window	Run time over 20 min
World builder	Batched every 15 min on metric change	Rebuild plot params, regenerate district manifest, push to CDN	Manifest older than 1h for an active district
Decay job	Nightly	Dim and darken plots by inactivity	Did not run
Integrity detector	Hourly	Flag commit bursts, trivial diffs, star velocity spikes, hold from leaderboard	Flag rate over 2% of active users
Presence reaper	Every minute	Expire presence heartbeats older than 5 min	Never, log only

Service	Trigger	What it does	Alert if
Token sweep	Hourly	Refresh expiring OAuth tokens, mark revoked accounts unverified	Refresh failure over 5%
District round scorer	Nightly, final at round close	Compute per-head participation score per district, roll up to city and continent, apply forfeits	Any district score moves over 0.2 in a day
District rebalancer	Weekly	Split districts over 60 average, merge under 15	Manual review on every split
Digest notifier	Daily at 8am user local time	Notes on your door, district activity, streak at risk	Send failure over 2%
Moderation processor	Realtime and queue	Route reports, auto-mute on threshold, voice transcript scan in moderated spaces	Queue age over 4h
Retention and deletion	Nightly	Execute delete requests after 30-day grace, purge expired exports, enforce region rules	Any delete older than 31 days
Backups	Hourly incremental, daily full	Postgres and manifests	Restore test fails monthly

Admin dashboards

Internal only. SSO, audit log on every action. Five screens for v1.

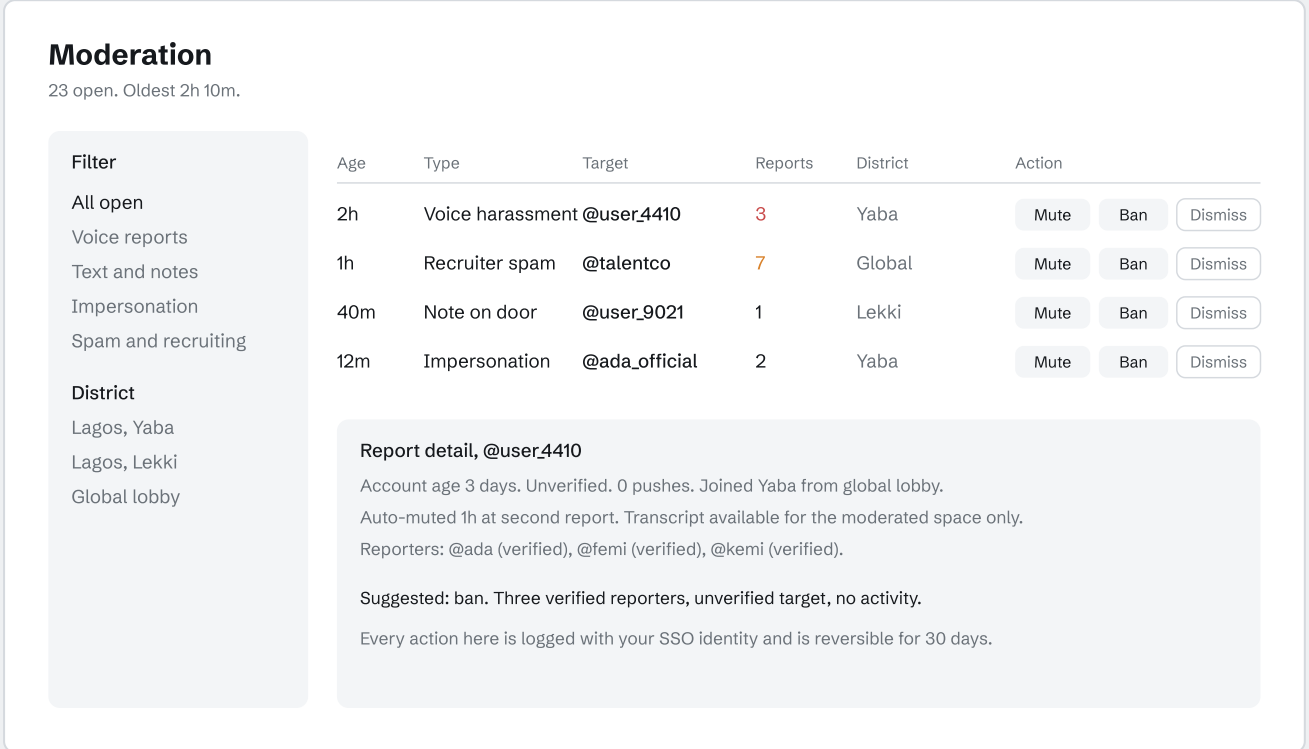
Ingestion health



Ingestion health. The four tiles map to the four alert thresholds in the services table.

Figure: Ingestion health. The four tiles map to the four alert thresholds in the services table.

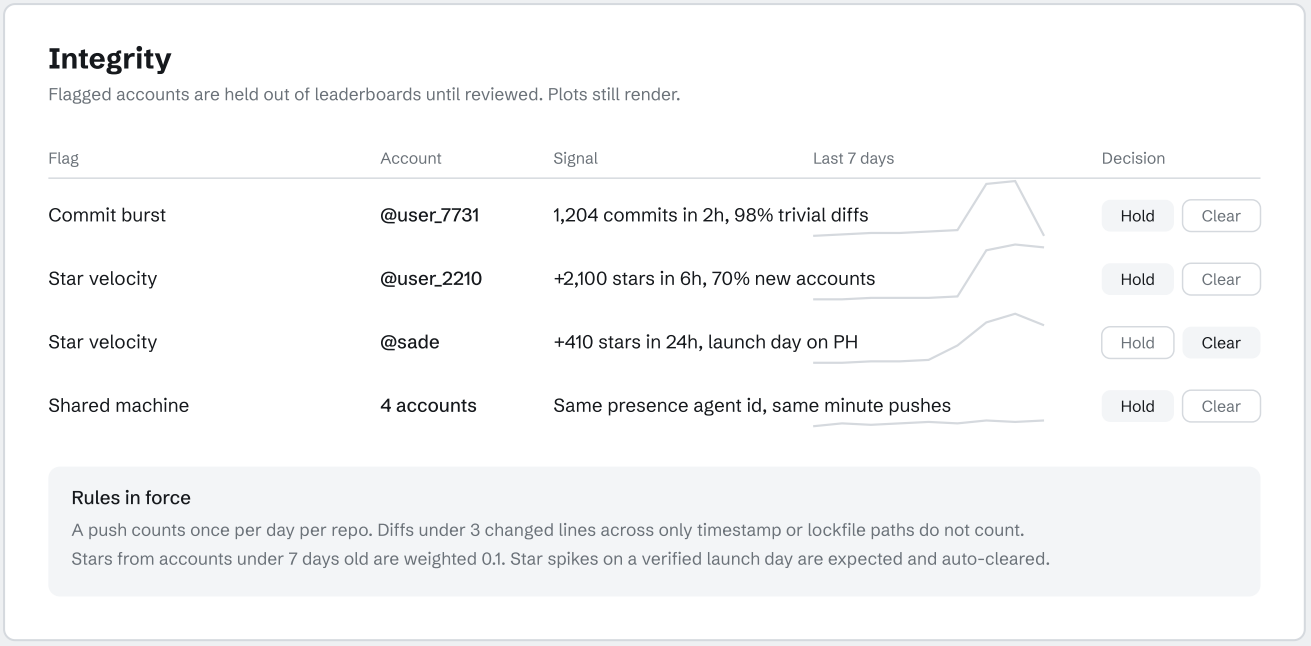
Moderation queue



Moderation queue. Reports from verified accounts are weighted higher. Suggested actions are shown, never auto-applied beyond a temporary mute.

Figure: Moderation queue. Reports from verified accounts are weighted higher. Suggested actions are shown, never auto-applied beyond a temporary mute.

Ranking integrity



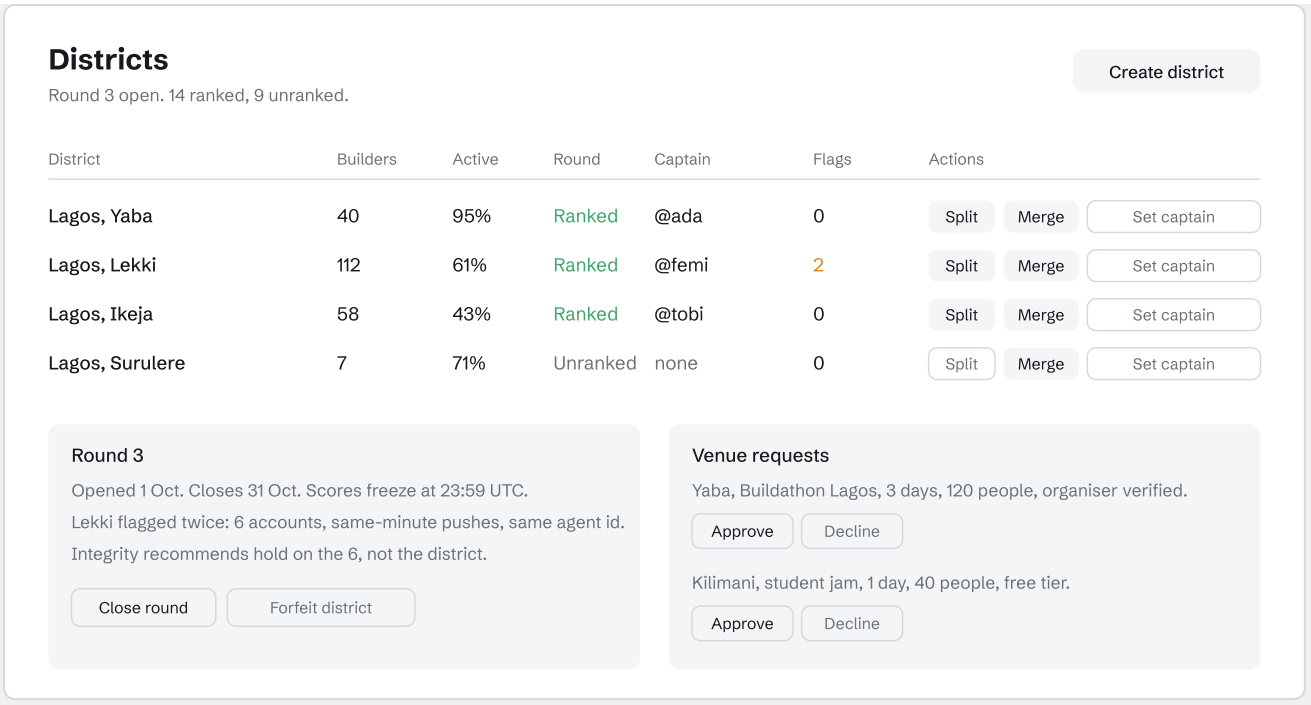
Integrity review. A genuine launch spike looks the same as a bought one at first glance. Verified Product Hunt launches auto-clear.

Figure: Integrity review. A genuine launch spike looks the same as a bought one at first glance. Verified Product Hunt launches auto-clear.

Users and verification

Search any user. See linked sources, verification state, token health, privacy settings as they set them, and their delete or export requests. Admins cannot see hidden MRR figures. Only the aggregate that the scoring job uses.

Districts



District management. Split and merge are manual here even though the rebalancer proposes them, because a split changes who someone's neighbours are. Setting a captain by hand is for emergencies only and is logged.

Figure: District management. Split and merge are manual here even though the rebalancer proposes them, because a split changes who someone's neighbours are. Setting a captain by hand is for emergencies only and is logged.

Privacy and security

- Read-only, minimum scopes on every OAuth connection. Tokens encrypted at rest in a secrets vault, never in Postgres.
- Private repos are never requested and never ingested, even where a scope would allow it.
- Raw payloads are discarded after normalisation. The system stores counts and figures, not content.
- Every metric has a visibility toggle. MRR is hidden by default.
- Location is city level only. Users can hide city and appear in a global district.
- One hosting region at launch. GDPR and NDPR aligned from day one: plain-language policy, one-click export, one-click delete with a 30-day grace.
- Admin actions are logged and reversible. Admin app is SSO only.
- Impersonation is prevented by verification. An unverified account cannot claim a verified name.

Environments and staging

Four environments. Nothing reaches production without passing through staging under replayed real traffic.

Environment	Data	Deploys	Purpose
Local	Docker Compose, fake GitHub and Stripe event generators	Developer machine	Build a feature end to end without touching a real platform
Dev	Shared, wiped weekly	Every merge to main	Integration between services
Staging	Synthetic city of 5,000 builders built from public GitHub Archive events, anonymised	Tagged release candidates	Replay 24h of recorded webhook traffic at 10x. Load test. Soak test.
Production	Real	Promoted from staging, canary first	Serve people

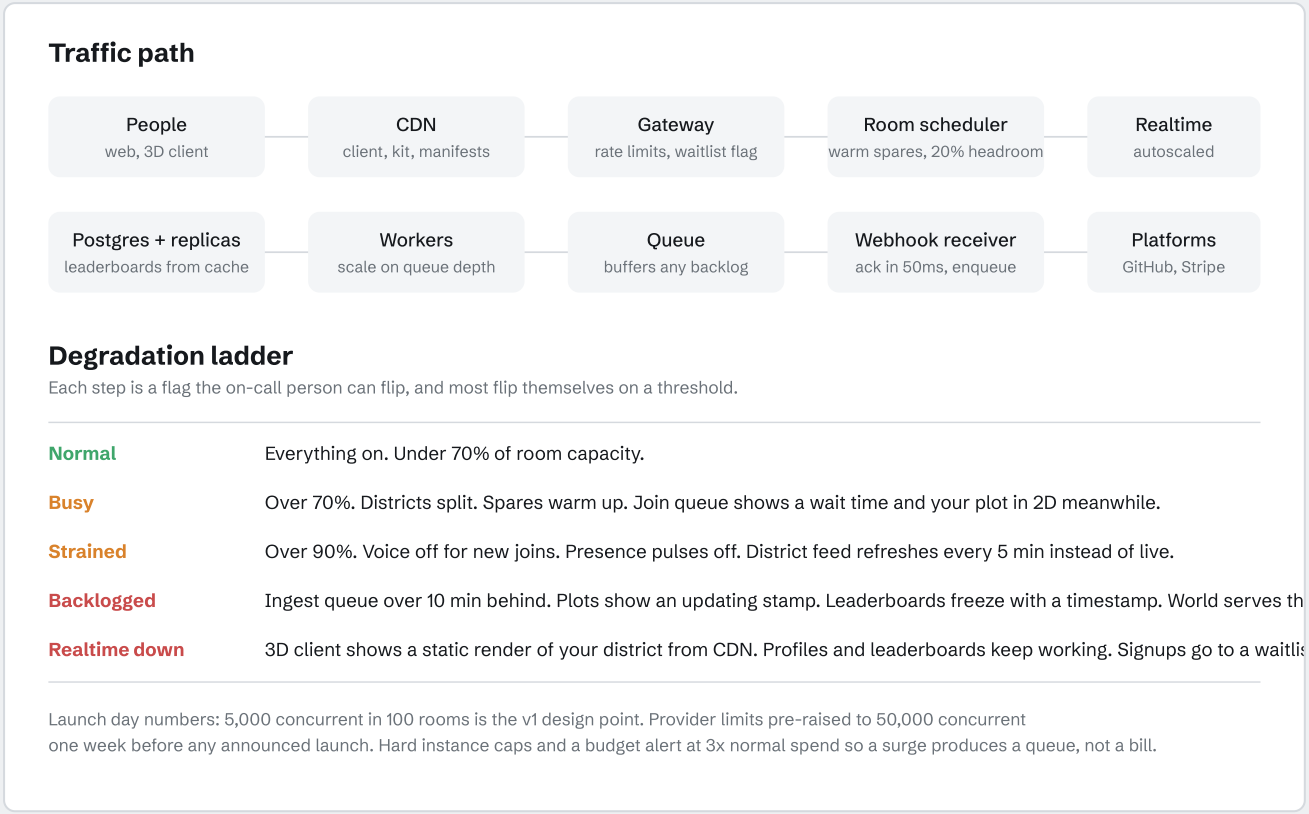
How a change gets out

i. Every user-facing change ships behind a feature flag, off by default.
ii. Backend deploys daily. The 3D client ships weekly, because clients are cached and people notice.
iii. World builder changes run on one district first as a canary. If the regenerated district passes visual checks and nobody reports breakage for 48 hours, it rolls to all districts overnight.
iv. Database migrations are expand then contract. Add the column, backfill, switch readers, drop the old column a release later. No migration ever blocks a deploy.
v. The asset kit is versioned. Every district manifest pins a kit version, so an old manifest always renders even after the kit moves on.
vi. Rollback is a flag flip or a manifest version pin. Both take under a minute and need no deploy.

Testing that matters here

- Replay harness: record a day of real webhooks with user ids hashed, replay into staging before any ingest change.
- Bot swarm: headless three.js clients that walk districts, open plot cards and talk. 2,000 of them against staging before each phase.
- Visual regression on district renders: screenshot every district type at kit build time, diff against the last approved set.
- Chaos: kill one realtime node in staging every week and confirm rooms migrate. Run the same drill in production once a month during low traffic.

Surge and resilience



The CDN holds the client, the asset kit and every district's last known manifest, so a visitor can always load a district even when nothing behind the gateway is healthy.

Surges will come from predictable places: the product's own Product Hunt launch, a viral post, a well-known builder joining, a city onboarding night. The rule is that the world degrades gracefully. It never falls over, and the flat profile site never goes down at all.

Figure: The CDN holds the client, the asset kit and every district's last known manifest, so a visitor can always load a district even when nothing behind the

gateway is healthy.

Infrastructure decisions

- One cloud region with three availability zones at launch. CDN is global. A second region only when a city on another continent has over 2,000 builders.
- Realtime rooms run on an autoscaling node pool. Scale on room count, not CPU, and keep 20% warm headroom. A room that loses its node migrates its players to a spare within 10 seconds.
- The webhook receiver only acknowledges and enqueues. It never does work in the request. GitHub and Stripe therefore never retry into a struggling system.
- Workers scale on queue depth. A backlog is a queue, which is fine, not an outage.
- Leaderboards and profiles are precomputed and served from cache. Nothing is calculated when a page loads.
- Postgres has one primary and two read replicas. All world and profile reads go to replicas.
- Voice is a managed service. It scales on its side, and it is the first thing switched off under load because it is the most expensive per user and the least essential.
- A signup waitlist flag sits at the gateway. It is the single most useful surge control: new accounts queue, existing accounts carry on.
- Backups hourly, restore tested monthly. Recovery target four hours, data loss target one hour.
- Public status page from day one. Say what is degraded before people ask.

AI models by job

No single model builds this. Each job has a different right tool, and most of the system has no model in it at all.

Job	Model or tool	Notes
Writing the codebase, procedural rules, shaders	Claude, GPT-6 Astra, Codex-class agents	Astra is a language model. It writes three.js, it does not render anything.
Rendering the world	three.js in the browser	No AI at runtime. Procedural generation from stored numbers.

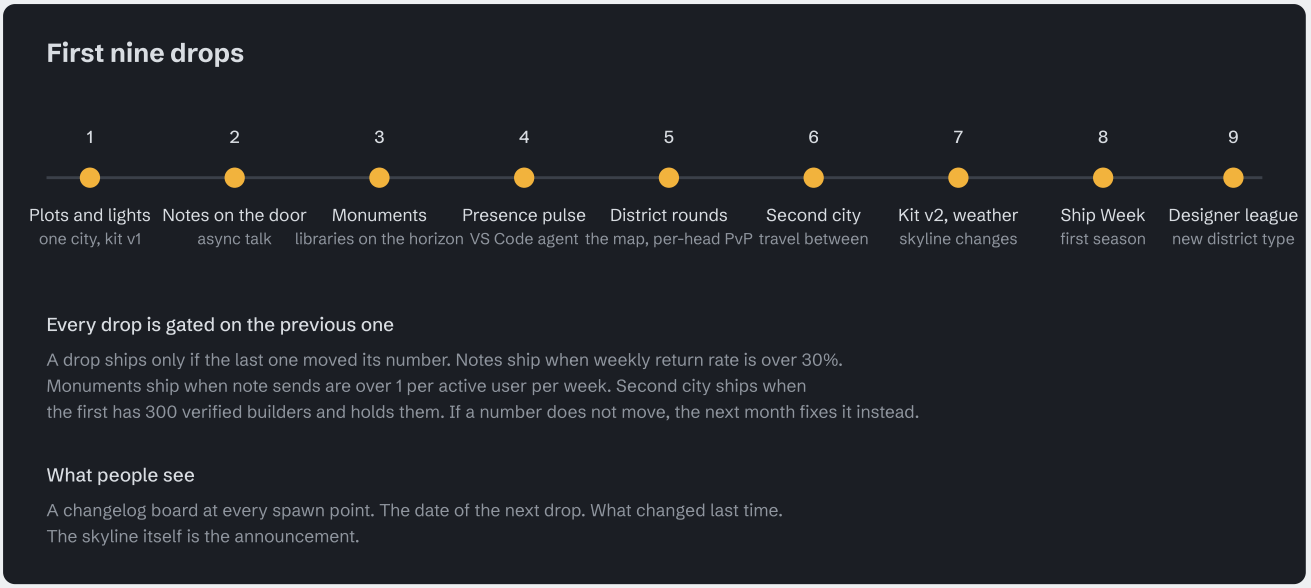
Job	Model or tool	Notes
The 30-piece building kit	Meshy, Tripo, Hunyuan3D, Rodin, with manual cleanup in Blender	Generate props and variants, then a human fixes topology. Not districts, single pieces.
Characters, street props and the community kit	Same generators for a base mesh, then rigging and cleanup in Blender	Stylised characters need faces, rigs and walk, sit and emote animations. The biggest asset cost in v1.1.
Texture variation	Flux or Stable Diffusion, offline	Baked into the asset kit, never generated live.
Repo summaries on plot cards	A small, cheap model such as Haiku-class	Runs in the ingest worker on README and recent commit messages. Cached.
Builder matching, "people like you nearby"	Embeddings model	Embed repo topics and languages. v2.
Voice moderation in moderated spaces	Streaming speech-to-text, then a safety classifier	Transcripts kept only for reported segments.
Text and note moderation	Safety classifier, Llama Guard class or vendor API	Flags to the queue, never auto-bans.
Anomaly detection	No model. Rules and statistics.	Thresholds are easier to explain to a flagged user than a classifier is.

Phases

i. Flat site. GitHub plus Stripe plus Product Hunt. Profile, verified metrics, one leaderboard per league. No 3D. Ship it in weeks, not months. Goal: 300 verified builders in Lagos, 20% connect Stripe.
ii. Lagos in 3D, starting with Yaba. Generated plots, presence agent, proximity voice, notes on the door. Loads in under 8 seconds on a mid-range phone connection. Goal: builders return at least twice a week unprompted.
iii. Second and third cities. District rounds and the map. GitLab. Digest notifier. Integrity dashboard hardened.

iv. Designers and creators as separate leagues. YouTube. Nomad mode.
v. Hosted hackathon venues. Scout and recruiter seats. Partner districts.

How the world improves month to month



Nine months, nine visible changes. The order is a proposal. The gating rule is not.

Weather was the month-seven drop in v1.0. In v1.1 rain and storms are part of the base look, so that drop is kit v2 alone. New community kit pieces and new kinds of build area are good candidates for monthly drops.

A world that never changes is a screenshot. Treat this like a live game: one visible drop a month, announced in advance, and every district regenerates overnight so people wake up to a changed skyline. Scores and history are never reset. Changes are additive.

Figure: Nine months, nine visible changes. The order is a proposal. The gating rule is not.

Rules for changing a live world

- One drop a month, same day each month, announced two weeks ahead on the changelog board and by digest.
- Additive only. New pieces, new districts, new mechanics. Nothing a builder earned is removed or re-scored. Scoring rule changes apply from the change date forward.

- Kit versions are permanent. A plot built with kit v1 can always be rendered with kit v1. Regeneration to a new kit is a choice made per district, canaried first.
- Monuments are earned, not placed. A library gets a monument when 25 verified builders in the world contribute to it. The threshold is public.
- Seasons are time-boxed. Ship Week runs seven days, has its own board, and leaves a permanent marker on every plot that took part. The main leaderboards are untouched.
- Small improvements ship continuously behind flags. The monthly drop is what gets announced, not the only thing that changes.

Telemetry that decides what to improve

You cannot improve a world you cannot see people using. From the first week the client reports, anonymised and aggregated:

- Where people stand. A heatmap per district. Empty streets get merged, crowded corners get space.
- Which plot cards get opened, and whether a note or a talk follows.
- Session length and return interval. The target is two visits a week unprompted.
- Where sessions end. If people leave from the leaderboard, the leaderboard is the problem.
- Join queue waits and degradation flags triggered, per district, per hour.

The monthly drop decision is made from these numbers and a short written review, not from the roadmap above. The roadmap is the plan until the data says otherwise.

Risks

- Retention. A 3D client competes with the IDE for attention. Mitigated by making the data layer the product and the world a short visit.
- Stripe trust. People may refuse to connect revenue. Mitigated by hidden-by-default and storing one number only. If connect rate stays under 10% in phase 1, rethink MRR entirely.
- Gaming. Every metric will be attacked. Mitigated by consistency weighting, verified-only inputs, and a hold-and-review queue.
- Cost. Realtime servers and voice scale with concurrency. Districts are capped so the ceiling is known.

- Platform dependence. GitHub or Stripe changing API terms would hurt. No mitigation beyond diversifying sources in phase 3.
- Safety. Open voice with strangers goes bad fast. Moderated default and verified-only speaking in moderated spaces.
- Look versus load. Textures, reflections, rain and characters cost download size and frame time. The phase 2 target is still under 8 seconds on a mid-range phone connection. Mitigated by quality tiers, compressed textures and a small first scene that streams the rest.
- Asset cost. Stylised characters, a textured kit and the community kit take real production time. Mitigated by finishing one street before scaling to a district.
- Griefing in build areas. Anything players can place will be abused. Mitigated by fixed areas, a curated kit with no uploads, snap points, piece limits and the same report flow as notes.

Out of scope for v1

- Influencer and follower-based rankings.
- LinkedIn, Behance, Dribbble, Figma as data sources.
- Replicas of real offices or hubs. Public landmarks on the skyline are fine.
- User-decorated personal plots, and building anywhere outside a community build area.
- Uploaded models, images or text in community builds. Only kit pieces.
- District prizes with cash value. Markers and standing only.
- Mobile 3D client. Mobile gets the flat profile and leaderboard.
- Any token, coin, NFT or tradable asset.

Open questions

- Which Lagos district seeds first after Yaba, and how the first 100 Yaba builders are recruited.
- Whether the presence agent ships in phase 1 or 2. It is cheap to build and it is the hook, but it is one more thing to install.
- Name.

Added in v1.1:

- Build rights. Can every resident build, or only verified builders? Is building earned through real work, and is there a daily limit?
- Build review. Can neighbours undo, vote on or report a piece? Does a district captain or an admin approve finished areas?
- Build area marker. What exactly marks an area in the world: a signpost, a painted outline, a light, or a mix?
- The people on the street. Are background people other players, simulated residents, or both? If simulated, how do we keep them from being mistaken for real builders?
- Builders Nearby shows what each person is doing. Does that come from their real work, from what they are building in the world, or from a status they type?
- Objectives. Who writes them, and are they only for onboarding or ongoing?
- Phases. The images describe the 3D world, and the team's proof of concept is 3D first. Phase 1 is still a flat site in this document. Confirm or change that.
- Onboarding. `docs/design/immersive-onboarding.md` describes an airport arrival with a flight. That is longer than the two-minute onboarding above. Decide which one wins.

Mockups are illustrative. Builder names and figures are invented. Lagos Life and Lagos Run figures are from public reports in the first week of October 2026.